

Lishu Zhang

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Academic Appointment

2025 - **Research Engineer** with Prof. Peter Tankov and Dr. Olivier David Zerbib, **CREST**, France.

Education

2021 - 2026(exp.) **Ph.D. in Economics, Tilburg University**, The Netherlands.
2019 - 2021 **Research Master in Economics, Tilburg University**, with distinction, The Netherlands.
2017 - 2019 **Master of Science in Economics, Stockholm School of Economics**, Sweden.
2013 - 2017 **Bachelor of Economics, Renmin University of China**, China

Research Interest

Broad fields: Financial economics, International Economics, Environmental Economics
Keywords: Climate Finance, Banking, Global Capital Markets, Corporate Finance

References

Prof. Harry Huizinga

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Dr. Louis Raes

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Dr. Guzman Ourens

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Working papers

Resistance and Arbitrage: International Trade in Brown Loans

Yihong Xia Best Paper Award, CICF 2025

[Job Market Paper]

I develop a novel measure of carbon sensitivity in lending to assess reductions in portfolio exposure to brown assets. Using syndicated loan data, I show that countries with greater resistance to brown lending, proxied by economic development, experience faster shifts in the sectoral composition of loan portfolios. The decarbonization is driven primarily by domestic credit reallocation. I find consistent evidence of risk transfers to less regulated lenders and foreign countries, indicating arbitrage and incomplete regulations. Furthermore, lenders' climate risk-taking and transfer behaviors vary sharply by syndicate role, loan type, and specialization. The existence of international trade in brown loans has important implications for supervisory evaluation. Using the European Central Bank's climate guide, I show that accounting for regulatory leakage reveals effects contrary to common wisdom.

International ownership of brown shares and economic development

with Harald Benink, Harry Huizinga, and Louis Raes.

Under Review at Management Science

[available on CEPR] [Press: VoxEU]

Using global share ownership data from 2002 to 2021, we provide evidence that a country's ownership share of carbon-intensive firms declines with its GDP per capita. This effect is primarily driven by investment managers that invest on behalf of others and long-term investors, and it is stronger for larger firms and firms in brown industries. Higher ownership by poorer countries is associated with higher emission and ESG-related incident intensities. Hence, the ownership transfer of brown firms from high-income to low-income countries can impede these firms' greening and more generally worsen their ESG performance.

When ESG information drives control: evidence from M&A deals

We study whether and how ESG information affects the allocation of corporate control using mergers and acquisitions. Conditional on deal occurrence, firms with an ESG information advantage are more likely to acquire control, consistent with higher expected synergy. While existing M&A research primarily emphasizes governance gains, we show that environmental

comparative advantage is a major determinant of the M&A direction. The impact of ESG information on control allocation is amplified in countries with stronger institutional quality and information environments. Additionally, ESG-informed firms are more likely to assume control when markets have rewarded ESG-informed firms that recently undertook M&As. Event-study results reveal asymmetric market perceptions of ESG information for acquirers and targets. The value added of ESG-informed control may also arise from reduced within-deal uncertainty, as stock financing is less likely and less intensive in such deals. Our result that ESG-informed firms are more likely to take control over traded assets implies that used asset trade can serve as a mechanism for reallocating control from less to more environmentally capable firms, facilitating the green transition.

Conferences and Seminars

AFA Poster Session (2026); CICF (2025); AsianFA PhD Consortium (2025); PhD-Economics Virtual Seminar (2025); FMA Annual Meeting (2024); ESSFM, Gerzensee, night session (2024); Canadian Economics Association Conference (2024); DEARE Workshop, Utrecht University (2024); Research Seminar ECON-CEDON, KU Leuven (2024); Brown Bag Seminar (Finance), Tilburg University (2024); Internal Seminar (Economics), Tilburg University (2023, 2024); Imperial College PhD Conference in Economics and Finance (2024).

Work in progress

Critical Raw Materials Risk with Peter Tankov and Olivier David Zerbib.

Constructs aggregate and firm-level critical raw materials risk measures and tests whether this risk is priced in global equity markets.

Teaching Experience

Macroeconomics 3 (PhD)	Spring 2022, 2023, 2024
Teaching Assistant, with Dr. Dajana Xani and Prof. Jeffrey Campbell, Tilburg University.	
Economics of the European Union (undergraduate)	Fall 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
Teaching Assistant, with Prof. Harald Benink and Prof. Harry Huizinga, Tilburg University.	
Economics of Banking and Finance (undergraduate)	Fall 2021, 2022
Teaching Assistant, with Prof. Harald Benink and Prof. Harry Huizinga, Tilburg University.	
International Economics (undergraduate)	Fall 2018
Teaching Assistant, with Prof. Paul Segerstrom, Stockholm School of Economics.	

Extracurricular Services

Tilburg PhD Platform (TiPP) , member	2021-2023
Graduate Students' Society (GSS) , representative of Research Master's in Economics	2019-2020

Awards & Scholarships

Koopmans Scholarship, Tilburg University	2019-2021
National Scholarship, Renmin University of China	2015
Outstanding School Cadre, Renmin University of China	2014

Languages

English, French (intermediate), Mandarin & Wu Chinese

Computational Skills

STATA, R, MATLAB, Python (Jupyter), LaTeX;
Proficient user of financial databases: Refinitiv Workspace, WRDS, Orbis, etc.